Being a team person always in life, it was but natural for me to make an appeal for 'Team Arunachal' and design an appropriate badge for it. We finally chose to make a badge and lapel pin with the hornbill motif on it. I have been liberally presenting the Team Arunachal badge to all citizens who do outstanding work. I have a cherished desire to see the majestic yellow-beaked Indian hornbill in full flight in Arunachal.

The natural beauty and the diversity of flora and fauna have placed Arunachal Pradesh amongst the very few remaining biodiversity hot spots of the world. The state has different climate zones, ranging from the glaciated and alpine climate along the Himalayas to the tropical rain forests in the foothills, with the cool and temperate region with coniferous forests in between. It is a part of the world with places where perhaps no human has ever set foot. There is over 82 per cent area under forest cover, which is amongst the highest in the country. It is also the most sparsely populated region of India with about 17 persons per square kilometre as against the national average of over 382 people. During the past three years alone, four new or extremely rare species of fauna have been found: a multicoloured small bird called Bugun Liocichia, a catfish with grey head and brown body (*Erethistoides senkhiensis*), a butterfly known as Bhutan Glory (*Bhutanis lidderdalii*) and recently, a rare mammal, Black Pika (*Ochotona nigrita*), sighted for the first time in India.

However, it was astonishing to see that despite the enormous potential for tourism, this sector had not seen commensurate development of infrastructure. [According to *Lonely Planet* (2012 edition), Arunachal Pradesh has been rated 'fourth' among the top-ten regions to be visited in the world.] Tourism had thus become one of my foremost thrust areas and I had to somehow get things moving on this front. Besides that, in my meetings with the concerned ministers in the central government, I stressed the need for making more areas accessible or opened up for tourists. Importantly, we also took up the case for issuance of the inner-line permit 'online' and for streamlining the procedures to make them tourist-friendly. In view of the absence of road communications,